

The Best Android Apps for Protecting Privacy and Keeping Information Secure



Privacy violations and data theft occur every day, making it necessary for all of us to safeguard our data. We trust our smartphones way too much and tend to store personal data on them, ignoring the fact that these devices could easily be compromised. However, there are a few open source apps that can ensure the data on your phone is not compromised. This article lists the best ones.

Everyone is becoming aware about information security. There are plenty of privacy and security apps available in the Google Play store too, but it is not easy to select the right one. Most users prefer free apps, but some of these offer only limited functionality and force users to upgrade to a premium membership, which many cannot afford.

This article sheds light on some FOSS Android apps that will really help in safeguarding your privacy.

Safe Notes

Safe Notes is a companion app for the Protected Text website (<https://www.protectedtext.com/>). It is an online encrypted notepad which offers space on a separate site for users to store their notes. To use this service, you do not need to sign up with the website. Instead, you need to choose a site name and a password to protect it.

You have two options to use Safe Notes — you can either use this app to save your notes locally, or you can import your existing Protected Text site in the app. In the latter case, you can

synchronise your notes between the app as well as in the Protected Text website.

By default, all the notes will be in an unlocked state. After you have saved your notes, if you want to encrypt them,

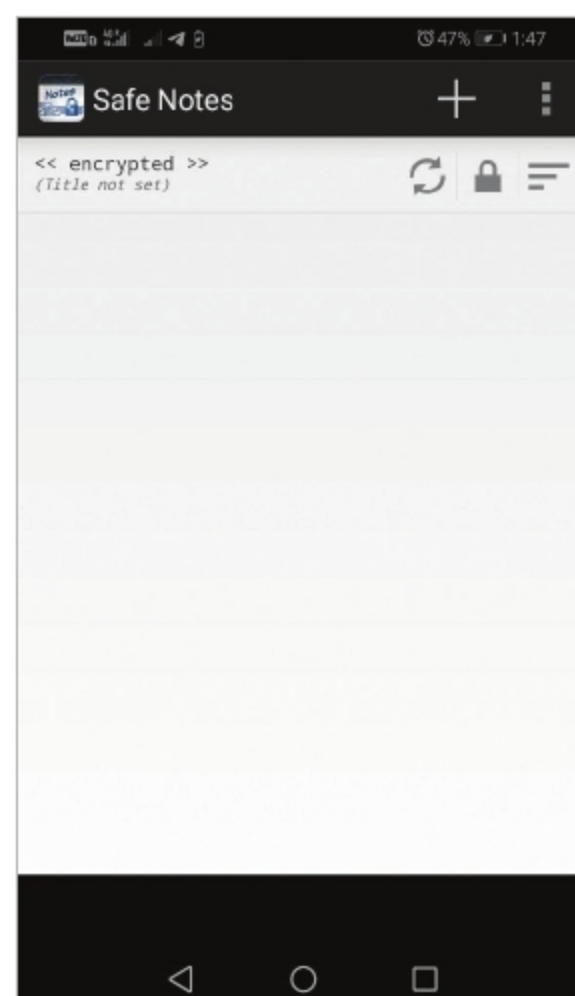


Figure 1: Safe Notes

click on the key icon beside your note and you will be prompted to give a password. After entering the password of your choice, your note will be encrypted and instead of the key icon, you will see an unlocked icon in its place, which means that your note is not locked. To lock your note, click the 'Unlocked' icon beside your note — your note will get locked and the password will be removed from your device.

Passwords that you are using are not transmitted anywhere. Even if you are using an existing Protected Text site, your passwords are not transmitted. Only your encrypted notes get sent to the Protected Text servers, so you are in total control. But this also means that you cannot recover your password if you lose it.

Your notes are encrypted by the AES algorithm and SHA 12 for hashing, while SSL is used for data transmission.

Exodus Privacy

Have you ever wondered how many permissions you are granting to an Android app? While you can see these